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Peoria police say missing 82-year-old found safe thanks to Flock cameras

The man's wife gave police the car he was driving and its license plate number, which was entered into the Flock system.



Police say an 82-year-old man reported missing was found safe hours later thanks to Flock cameras. Zach Prelutsky reports why some don't support the tech.



PEORIA, AZ (AZFamily) — Peoria police say an 82-year-old man who had been reported missing on Monday was found safe hours later thanks to Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) cameras.

On Monday, a woman called Peoria police to report that her husband never made it to a scheduled doctor's appointment and was concerned because that was unusual for him. He also suffers from multiple medical conditions, as well as reported cognitive decline.

"Traditionally, we probably would not have found him unless he returned home because we would have not known where in the Valley he was at," said Commander Jason Tarrant with Peoria Police during a press conference on Tuesday.

The man's wife gave police the car he was driving and its license plate number, which was entered into the Flock system.

Peoria police say the system gave officers information about the vehicle's location and direction. He had been tracked driving as far away as Scottsdale. Eventually the man was found by officers on Bell Road just outside of Peoria, nearly out of fuel and unaware of where he had been.

"This is probably the single most impactful tool that I have seen in the law enforcement realm because it's able to scan every vehicle," said Peoria Police Chief Thomas Intrieri.

A [recent Flock network audit obtained by Arizona's Family](#) through a public records request found that between July 14 and Aug. 14, Peoria police made 1,290 searches of the Flock system with 152 of those being for missing, endangered or runaway people.

Not everybody in the city is in favor of this technology, even in lieu of this week's success story.

During public comment in Tuesday's Peoria City Council meeting, multiple people spoke up with

“We generally support the competitive edge against local crime and saving lives, absolutely, but deploying a city-scaled surveillance system interconnected with neighboring jurisdictions through the same vendor without tactical comms, a road map. It’s just an egregious breach of our trust honestly,” one woman said.

Peoria police [began using Flock cameras in early 2025](#) and now have 79 ALPR cameras around the city, recently adding four more.

Chief Intrieri said there have not been any conversations of canceling the Flock contract.

“We recognize this is merely a technology that requires human intervention,” he said.

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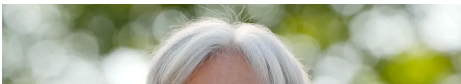
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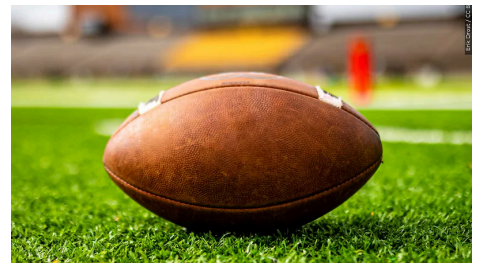
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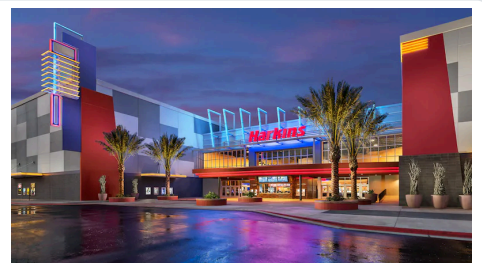
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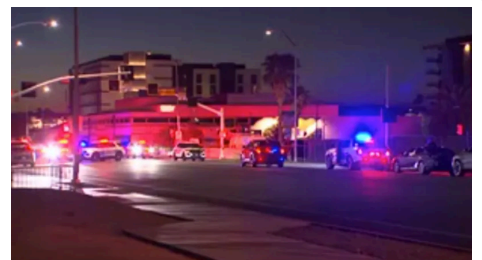
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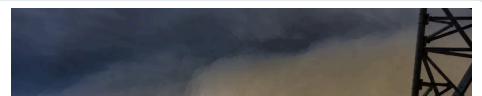
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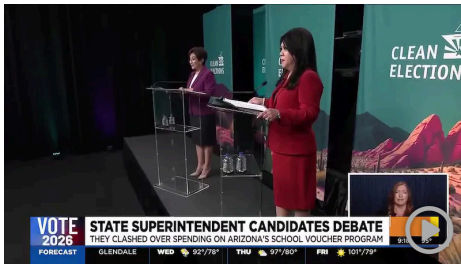
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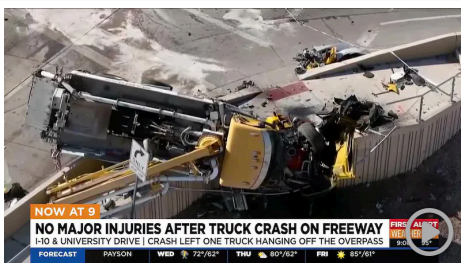
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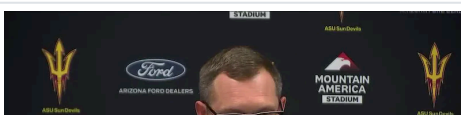
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